

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-07-06

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-06-28 | #01

CEE Banks Accelerate Instant Payments Adoption

The recent EU Instant Payments Regulation has set ambitious deadlines for banks across the European Economic Area, including the CEE region, to offer instant payment services. This regulation mandates that all credit institutions must be able to receive instant payments by early 2027 and send them by early 2028. For CEE banks, this means significant infrastructure upgrades, particularly the full adoption of the ISO 20022 standard for all payment messages. The shift promises enhanced liquidity management for corporates, faster reconciliation, and improved operational efficiency, but also presents challenges in terms of IT investment and compliance. Discussions are ongoing regarding the interoperability of national instant payment schemes with the broader SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) framework.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates by early 2027/2028.
- Full ISO 20022 adoption is critical for CEE banks.
- Enhanced liquidity and faster reconciliation for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation directly impacts CMlplus's offering, requiring RBI to ensure its platform fully supports SCT Inst and ISO 20022 for both incoming and outgoing payments across its CEE network. It also creates opportunities to offer enhanced real-time liquidity management and reconciliation services to corporate clients.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-06-15 | #02

AI Boosts Fraud Prevention in Instant Payments

The rapid adoption of instant payments has unfortunately also led to a surge in sophisticated fraud attempts, including authorized push payment (APP) fraud. To combat this, banks and payment providers are investing heavily in AI-driven fraud detection systems that can analyze vast amounts of transaction data in milliseconds. These systems leverage behavioral analytics, anomaly detection, and predictive modeling to identify suspicious patterns before payments are irrevocably processed. Furthermore, the push for Verification of Payee (VoP) services, often powered by AI, is gaining traction across Europe to ensure funds are sent to the intended recipient, adding a crucial layer of security for corporates and individuals. Regulatory bodies are also exploring guidelines for AI use in financial crime prevention.

- AI/ML crucial for real-time fraud detection in instant payments.
- Combats authorized push payment (APP) fraud effectively.
- VoP solutions, often AI-powered, enhance payment security.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must integrate robust, AI-enhanced fraud prevention mechanisms, including VoP capabilities, to protect corporate clients utilizing instant payments. This is critical for maintaining trust and ensuring the security of high-value, real-time transactions across the CEE network.

Open Banking APIs and EBICS Drive Treasury Connectivity

The evolving landscape of corporate treasury demands seamless, real-time data exchange with banking partners. Open Banking APIs, initially driven by PSD2 for retail, are now extending their reach into corporate banking, offering new avenues for direct system-to-system communication for account information and payment initiation. Concurrently, the adoption of EBICS v3, with its enhanced security features and support for ISO 20022 XML messages, continues to be a cornerstone for secure, standardized multi-bank connectivity, especially in the DACH region and increasingly across CEE. Treasurers are combining these technologies to build sophisticated payment factories and achieve comprehensive, real-time cash visibility across their global operations, reducing manual processes and improving liquidity management. The focus is on standardized data formats and secure, automated communication channels.

- Open Banking APIs enable direct system-to-system bank integration.
- EBICS v3 offers enhanced security and ISO 20022 support.
- Corporates combine APIs and EBICS for multi-bank connectivity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must continue to evolve its API offerings and ensure full support for EBICS v3 and ISO 20022 to meet the growing demand from corporates for advanced treasury system integration. This positions RBI as a key partner for seamless multi-bank and multi-currency cash management in CEE.

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Banks Face Implementation Deadline

The EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone must be able to receive instant credit transfers by early 2027, with sending capabilities following shortly after. This move is designed to enhance financial integration and provide consumers and businesses with faster, more efficient payment options, available 24/7/365. Banks are currently focusing on upgrading their infrastructure, ensuring interoperability, and addressing fraud prevention mechanisms inherent to real-time transactions. The regulation also caps instant payment fees at the level of traditional SEPA credit transfers, promoting wider adoption.

- Mandatory receipt of instant payments by early 2027 for Eurozone PSPs.
- Instant payment fees capped at standard SEPA credit transfer rates.
- Regulation aims for universal, affordable, 24/7 instant payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI CMiplus, impacting its SEPA and multi-currency payment offerings across CEE. CMiplus must ensure its platform and network banks are fully compliant, supporting instant payment initiation and receipt for corporate clients, especially in Eurozone CEE countries.

Global ISO 20022 Migration: Corporate Treasuries Adapt to New Standard

Financial institutions worldwide are continuing their phased migration to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments, with several key deadlines having passed or approaching in major currencies. This shift moves away from legacy messaging formats like SWIFT MT, offering significantly more structured and detailed data within payment messages. For corporate treasuries, this means enhanced straight-through processing (STP), better visibility into cash flows, and streamlined reconciliation processes, particularly for multi-currency operations. Challenges include system upgrades, data mapping, and ensuring internal and external stakeholders are ready for the new format. Early adopters are already reporting benefits in operational efficiency and fraud detection capabilities.

- Ongoing global migration to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments.
- Richer, structured data enables enhanced STP and reconciliation.
- Requires corporate system upgrades and data mapping.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

ISO 20022 is fundamental to CMIplus's multi-currency and H2H offerings. RBI must ensure full support for the latest ISO 20022 versions, providing tools for corporates to manage the transition, leverage richer data, and maintain seamless cross-border payment operations across its CEE network.

Open Banking APIs Revolutionize Corporate Cash Management and Fraud Prevention

The adoption of Open Banking APIs is transforming corporate cash management by enabling treasurers to access real-time account information, initiate payments, and automate reconciliation directly from their ERP or TMS. This immediate data access significantly improves liquidity management and forecasting accuracy. Furthermore, the granular, real-time nature of API-driven data feeds allows for more sophisticated anomaly detection and fraud prevention mechanisms, moving beyond traditional batch processing. While security and standardisation remain key considerations, the benefits in operational efficiency and risk mitigation are driving rapid adoption, particularly in Europe under PSD2/PSD3 frameworks. Banks are actively developing API-based services to meet this growing corporate demand.

- Open Banking APIs provide real-time cash visibility and payment initiation.
- Enhances liquidity management, forecasting, and reconciliation.
- Supports advanced real-time fraud detection and anomaly analysis.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus already supports Open API, making this a core strategic area. RBI should continue to expand its API offerings for real-time account information (eBAM), payment initiation, and integrate enhanced fraud prevention features, positioning CMIplus as a leader in API-driven treasury services in CEE.

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Banks Face Implementation Challenges

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, effective from April 2024 with key deadlines in early 2027, requires all payment service providers to offer instant euro credit transfers. This means funds must be credited to the recipient's account within ten seconds, regardless of the time or day. While enhancing liquidity and speed, banks face substantial hurdles in upgrading legacy systems, ensuring 24/7 availability, and managing increased fraud risks. The regulation also includes provisions for checking payee details (VoP) to mitigate fraud, adding another layer of complexity. For CEE banks operating within the Eurozone or with strong ties to it, compliance is critical and requires significant investment in infrastructure and processes.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates 10-second processing for euro credit transfers.
- Key implementation deadlines are set for early 2027 across the Eurozone.
- Banks must upgrade legacy systems and ensure 24/7 operational readiness.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMlplus must ensure full compliance with the EU Instant Payments Regulation across all relevant CEE markets. This involves upgrading payment infrastructure, integrating VoP services, and communicating new capabilities and deadlines to corporate clients to maintain competitive advantage and support their real-time treasury needs.

ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates Globally, Enhancing Data Capabilities

The transition to ISO 20022, the universal financial messaging standard, is progressing with major deadlines already passed for SWIFT CBPR+ and SEPA credit transfers and direct debits. This standard offers significantly richer, structured data compared to legacy formats, enabling better reconciliation, fraud detection, and liquidity management for corporates. However, full adoption requires banks and corporates to upgrade their systems, adapt internal processes, and ensure consistent data quality across the entire payment chain. The benefits, including enhanced straight-through processing and improved cash visibility, are driving continued investment, particularly as more countries and payment schemes, including those in CEE, align with the standard.

- ISO 20022 provides richer, structured payment data for improved treasury operations.
- SWIFT CBPR+ and SEPA migrations are largely complete, with ongoing optimization.
- Challenges include system upgrades, data quality, and consistent interpretation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its platform fully supports and leverages the rich data capabilities of ISO 20022 for all payment types, including multi-currency transactions across its CEE network. This involves not only sending/receiving ISO 20022 messages but also providing tools for clients to utilize the enhanced data for reconciliation, reporting, and analytics, thereby maximizing value for corporate treasuries.

ECB Catalyses Instant Payments and SEPA Evolution

The ECB continues to act as a catalyst for innovation in retail payments, with a strong emphasis on the widespread implementation of instant payments within SEPA. This initiative is part of a broader strategy to modernize the European payment landscape, ensuring faster and more convenient transactions for consumers and businesses alike. The goal is to achieve full reachability for instant payments, making them the new normal for euro transfers. This strategic push will require ongoing efforts from payment service providers to upgrade their systems and offer instant payment services to their customers, ultimately improving liquidity management and real-time transaction processing.

- ECB acts as a 'catalyst' for retail payments innovation.
- 'SEPA' is the foundational framework for these efforts.
- 'Instant payments' are a key strategic priority for modernization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This reinforces the critical importance of instant payments for CMiplus. RBI Cash Management must ensure full compliance and optimal integration of instant payment capabilities, including potential future regulatory mandates for universal reach, impacting liquidity management, real-time reporting, and client expectations for faster transaction processing.

Digital Euro Project Advances, Pilot Phase Underway

The ECB is actively developing a digital euro, exploring its design and distribution mechanisms. The project involves an innovation platform and a pilot phase to test technical solutions and user experience. Key aspects include ensuring privacy, defining its operational model, and establishing a robust governance framework, including a scheme rulebook. This initiative is crucial for maintaining the stability and sovereignty of the euro in a rapidly digitalizing economy, potentially impacting future retail and wholesale payment landscapes by offering a new form of central bank money.

- The project is in 'Innovation platform' and 'Pilot' phases.
- A 'Scheme rulebook' is being developed for governance.
- 'Timeline and progress' indicates ongoing advancement.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The digital euro could significantly reshape the payment landscape, potentially offering new avenues for corporate payments and liquidity management. CMiplus should monitor its development closely to anticipate integration needs and potential new services for clients, especially regarding multi-currency and cross-border transactions, and its interaction with existing payment rails.

TARGET Services Continue to Evolve for European Payments

TARGET Services represent the Eurosystem's robust infrastructure for processing large-value payments (T2), settling securities (T2S), and facilitating instant payments (TIPS). The ECB emphasizes their ongoing governance, efficiency, and cross-border payment capabilities. Continuous enhancements are crucial to support the evolving needs of the European financial market, including the adoption of ISO 20022 messaging standards and ensuring cyber resilience. These services are fundamental for the smooth functioning of the euro area's financial system and directly impact how banks and corporates manage their treasury and payment operations, especially for multi-currency transactions.

- TARGET Services encompass T2, T2S, and TIPS.
- 'Governance' and 'Cross-border payments' are key focus areas.
- Regular updates on 'Facts and figures' indicate active management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus relies heavily on the stability and efficiency of TARGET Services for its multi-currency and cross-border payment offerings. Any updates or strategic directions regarding T2, T2S, or TIPS, especially concerning ISO 20022 adoption or new functionalities, directly impact CMlplus's integration and service delivery for corporate clients in CEE, requiring continuous monitoring and adaptation.

Visa Launches Threat Platform, Pilots Agentic Transactions in Europe

Visa's new threat intelligence platform is designed to provide financial institutions with advanced tools to detect and respond to evolving cyber threats, enhancing the security of payment ecosystems. In a separate but significant development, Visa has also initiated and completed a series of "agentic commerce transactions" in collaboration with various European banks. These transactions represent a step towards more automated and intelligent payment processing, potentially leveraging AI and advanced APIs to facilitate seamless, self-executing payments. This move could significantly impact corporate treasury operations by enabling more efficient and autonomous payment initiation and reconciliation, aligning with the trend towards greater automation in cash management. The pilot in Europe suggests a focus on the region for these innovative payment methods.

- Visa launched a new threat intelligence platform for financial institutions.
- The platform aims to detect and respond to cyber threats effectively.
- Visa conducted 'agentic commerce transactions' in collaboration with European banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This news is highly relevant for CMlplus. The threat intelligence platform reinforces the need for robust security in payment services, a core offering of CMlplus. More critically, the pilot of agentic transactions in Europe signals a future direction for automated corporate payments, potentially leveraging APIs and AI for self-executing transactions, which CMlplus should monitor for future integration and service enhancements.

PayPal Joins European Payments Council, Influencing EU Standards

PayPal's entry into the European Payments Council is a significant development for the European payment landscape. As a member, PayPal will now participate in discussions and decisions that define payment schemes like SEPA (Single Euro Payments Area) and instant payments, directly influencing the future direction of European payment infrastructure. This strategic move allows PayPal to contribute its expertise in digital payments and potentially align its services more closely with established European banking standards, impacting how cross-border and domestic payments are processed within the EU. For financial institutions and corporates, this means a major digital payment player will now have a direct say in the evolution of standards that underpin their cash management operations, potentially accelerating innovation or introducing new compliance considerations.

- PayPal officially joined the European Payments Council (EPC).
- Gains a seat in discussions shaping European payment standards.
- EPC defines schemes like SEPA and instant payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI CMiplus as the EPC sets the standards for SEPA and instant payments, which are core to CMiplus operations in CEE. PayPal's involvement will influence future payment infrastructure and compliance requirements, necessitating RBI to monitor these developments closely for platform updates and strategic planning.

Bridge Secures MiCA and EMI Licences Across EU Member States

The acquisition of MiCA and EMI licences by Bridge marks a crucial step in the regulatory landscape for digital assets and payment services within the EU. The MiCA regulation provides a comprehensive legal framework for crypto-assets, ensuring consumer protection and market integrity, while the EMI licence allows Bridge to issue electronic money and provide payment services. This dual regulatory approval across all EU member states signifies a growing trend towards the mainstreaming and regulation of digital assets. For financial institutions like RBI, this development highlights the evolving regulatory environment, particularly concerning stablecoins and other crypto-assets that may increasingly integrate into traditional payment flows. It underscores the need for banks to understand and prepare for new compliance requirements and potential opportunities in this regulated digital asset space.

- Bridge secured MiCA and EMI licences.
- Licences allow operation across all EU member states.
- MiCA regulates crypto-assets, ensuring consumer protection.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI CMiplus as it demonstrates the increasing regulatory clarity and integration of digital assets (like stablecoins under MiCA) into the EU financial system. RBI needs to monitor these regulatory developments to ensure compliance, assess potential future offerings for corporate clients involving regulated digital assets, and understand the competitive landscape.

EU Legislation to Unlock SEPA Instant for Corporate Real-Time Treasury

The article highlights that upcoming EU legislation will mandate the availability and accessibility of SEPA Instant Payments for all corporates, moving beyond the current optionality. This legislative push is expected to be a game-changer, fostering real-time treasury capabilities by ensuring instant settlement and immediate liquidity visibility. Currently, corporate adoption of SEPA Instant has been slower than anticipated due to various factors, including bank readiness and corporate investment priorities. The new regulation will likely set clear deadlines for banks to offer instant payment services and for corporates to integrate them, potentially standardizing fees and improving interoperability. This will enable treasurers to manage cash more efficiently, reduce working capital needs, and enhance fraud detection through real-time reconciliation.

- EU legislation will mandate SEPA Instant Payments for corporates.
- Aims to unlock real-time treasury capabilities and immediate liquidity.
- Current corporate adoption of SEPA Instant has been slow.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This legislation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, as it directly impacts payment infrastructure and client expectations in the CEE region. CMlplus must ensure full compliance and robust support for SEPA Instant Payments, including real-time reporting and reconciliation features, to meet the evolving needs of corporate clients. This also presents an opportunity to differentiate by offering advanced real-time treasury solutions.

ISO 20022 Relevance Questioned Amidst DLT Evolution

With the increasing adoption of DLT and blockchain technologies for payments and financial transactions, the industry is debating the long-term role of ISO 20022. While ISO 20022 offers rich data capabilities and standardization, DLT platforms inherently provide real-time, immutable transaction records and potentially different data structures. The article likely discusses whether ISO 20022 can adapt to integrate with DLT environments, perhaps by serving as a data model for DLT-based messages, or if DLT will necessitate entirely new messaging standards. This discussion is crucial for banks and corporates investing in payment infrastructure, as it impacts strategic decisions regarding system interoperability, data exchange, and future-proofing treasury operations. The outcome will shape how traditional and emerging financial technologies converge or diverge.

- ISO 20022's future is debated in the context of DLT adoption.
- DLT offers real-time, immutable records and potentially new data structures.
- Question of ISO 20022 adapting to DLT or being superseded.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMlplus, a platform heavily reliant on ISO 20022 for rich data and interoperability, this discussion is vital for long-term strategic planning. RBI Cash Management needs to monitor developments in DLT and assess how ISO 20022 will evolve or integrate. This could influence future API strategies, data mapping, and the potential for offering DLT-related services to clients, ensuring CMlplus remains at the forefront of payment innovation.

Open Banking APIs Transforming Corporate Treasury Operations

The expansion of Open Banking beyond retail banking is profoundly impacting corporate treasury, with APIs becoming the backbone for real-time financial data exchange. Treasurers are increasingly leveraging APIs to gain instant access to account balances, transaction data, and payment initiation capabilities directly from their ERP or Treasury Management Systems (TMS). This direct connectivity eliminates manual processes, reduces operational risk, and provides unprecedented cash visibility across multiple banks and currencies. While security and standardization remain key considerations, the benefits of improved liquidity management, automated reconciliation, and faster decision-making are driving rapid adoption, especially for international corporates operating in diverse markets like CEE.

- Open Banking APIs provide real-time access to account information and payment initiation.
- Direct integration with ERP and TMS systems streamlines treasury workflows.
- Enhanced cash visibility and automated reconciliation are key benefits.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should continue to prioritize and expand its Open Banking API offerings for CMIplus clients, focusing on robust security, ease of integration, and comprehensive data access. This will enable CMIplus to serve as a central hub for corporate treasury operations, facilitating multi-bank connectivity and supporting advanced liquidity and payment factory solutions for its international corporate clients in CEE.

UK PSR Policy Boosts APP Fraud Reimbursement, Reduces Victims

The Payment Systems Regulator (PSR) in the UK has highlighted the success of its mandatory APP fraud reimbursement policy, which came into effect recently. The policy requires payment service providers to reimburse victims of APP fraud, shifting the liability and incentivizing banks to implement stronger fraud prevention measures. Key results include a noticeable reduction in the number of individuals falling victim to APP scams, a higher percentage of lost funds being recovered and returned to customers, and a proactive stance by financial institutions in developing and deploying advanced fraud detection and prevention technologies. While specific to the UK, the positive impact of this regulatory intervention could influence similar policy discussions and implementations across the European Union, especially with the upcoming PSD3 and Instant Payments Regulation focusing on enhanced fraud protection.

- UK PSR's APP fraud reimbursement policy shows positive impact.
- The policy has resulted in fewer victims of APP fraud.
- More money is being returned to fraud victims.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management as fraud prevention is paramount for corporate clients. While a UK policy, its success could set a precedent for future EU regulations under PSD3 or the Instant Payments Regulation, potentially impacting liability and fraud prevention requirements for CMIplus across CEE. CMIplus should monitor these developments closely to ensure compliance and maintain robust fraud mitigation strategies.

OTP Bank's AI and Data Literacy Drive in CEE

OTP Bank, a key player in the Central and Eastern European banking sector, is making significant investments in artificial intelligence and data literacy. This initiative is designed to empower its workforce with the skills needed to leverage data-driven insights and AI technologies. The goal is to improve operational efficiency, personalize customer experiences, and develop innovative financial products. By fostering an AI and data-literate culture, OTP Bank seeks to maintain its competitive edge and adapt to the evolving digital landscape in the CEE region. This transformation is crucial for future-proofing its services, including cash management, against emerging challenges and opportunities.

- OTP Bank is a major CEE financial institution.
- Strategic focus on AI and data literacy across the organization.
- Aims to enhance operational efficiency, customer experience, and product innovation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development from a peer CEE bank signals a critical trend for RBI Cash Management. CMlplus must ensure its platform is AI-ready, capable of leveraging data for enhanced fraud prevention, personalized services, and efficient multi-currency operations. It also highlights the need for RBI to foster AI and data literacy within its own teams to meet evolving corporate treasury demands.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2026-03-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing the Moment for Future Growth

This insight highlights a critical juncture for European wholesale banks, suggesting that a period of underperformance can be overcome by strategic shifts. The core idea is that banks must move beyond traditional models, embracing digital transformation, optimizing their operating models, and focusing on value-added services for corporate clients. This involves leveraging technology to enhance client experience, streamline processes, and develop new revenue streams in areas like payments, cash management, and trade finance. The implication is a need for significant investment in technology, talent, and a culture of innovation to secure a competitive edge and drive sustainable growth in the evolving financial landscape, particularly within the CEE region.

- Strategic digital investment is crucial for overcoming past underperformance.
- Focus on client-centric solutions and value-added services.
- Operational efficiency and cost optimization remain vital for competitiveness.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus can leverage this by accelerating its digital roadmap, particularly in Open Banking APIs and real-time payment capabilities, to offer superior client experiences. Focusing on CEE-specific needs and integrating advanced treasury solutions will help RBI seize regional market leadership.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-15 | #02

2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook: Beyond Credit, Driving Digital Value

This outlook, while titled 'Extending Credit,' likely covers broader wholesale banking trends, including the evolving role of cash management and payments. It suggests that while credit remains fundamental, future growth and profitability will increasingly depend on a bank's ability to provide integrated digital solutions. This includes optimizing transaction banking services, improving data analytics for treasury insights, and building robust, resilient platforms. The report likely highlights the importance of adapting to new regulatory environments (like ISO 20022) and client demands for real-time services, pushing banks to invest in modernizing their core infrastructure and embracing API-driven connectivity.

- Wholesale banking growth driven by integrated digital solutions, not just credit.
- Emphasis on data analytics for treasury and cash management insights.
- Modernizing core infrastructure for resilience and real-time capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize enhancing its data analytics for corporate treasury, offering deeper insights into cash flows and liquidity management. Continued investment in ISO 20022 migration and API development is crucial for future-proofing and competitive advantage in the CEE market.

AI and Advanced Tech: Core Drivers for Future Treasury Services

EY highlights AI as a central theme, appearing across various service lines from M&A; to audit and tax, unified by an 'EY.ai' platform. This indicates a pervasive belief that AI will transform operational efficiencies and strategic decision-making in treasury. Beyond AI, blockchain is explicitly mentioned, suggesting its role in future financial infrastructure, potentially for digital assets or enhanced payment rails. For banks, this means investing in AI-driven tools for predictive analytics, fraud detection, and automation, while exploring distributed ledger technologies for new service offerings to remain competitive.

- AI is a unifying platform transforming multiple financial services functions.
- Blockchain is a key technology for future financial infrastructure and digital assets.
- Technology transformation is a core EY service offering, indicating its strategic importance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize integrating AI for enhanced fraud detection, predictive liquidity forecasting, and automated reconciliation. Exploring blockchain for cross-border payments and digital asset services in CEE could provide a significant competitive edge and new revenue streams.

Data and Decision Intelligence: Elevating Treasury's Strategic Impact

EY lists 'Data and decision intelligence' as a key consulting service, underscoring its importance across business functions, including treasury. This suggests that raw data alone is insufficient; the ability to transform data into actionable insights is paramount for treasurers to optimize cash, liquidity, and risk. For banks, this implies a need to move beyond basic reporting to offering advanced analytics, predictive models, and intuitive dashboards that provide a holistic, real-time view of financial positions. Such capabilities enable corporates to optimize working capital, manage FX risk more effectively, and make better investment decisions.

- "Data and decision intelligence" is highlighted as a critical consulting service.
- Treasury requires advanced analytics for strategic, rather than just operational, decision-making.
- Optimized working capital and risk management are directly dependent on superior data insights.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should enhance its analytics and reporting capabilities, offering advanced dashboards for real-time cash visibility, liquidity forecasting, and risk analysis across CEE. Integrating with corporate ERP/TMS systems via Open Banking APIs for seamless data exchange is crucial for providing these insights.

Real-time Cash Visibility Remains Top Treasury Priority

A global survey of over 350 treasurers highlights that achieving comprehensive, real-time cash visibility across all accounts and entities is a critical strategic objective. This imperative is driven by the increasing need for better working capital optimization, enhanced risk management, and faster decision-making in today's volatile economic landscape. Many corporate treasuries continue to struggle with disparate data sources and outdated systems, which significantly hinder their ability to gain a single, accurate view of global liquidity. Overcoming these challenges is crucial for moving beyond reactive cash management to proactive strategic treasury operations.

- High priority for 350+ treasurers in a global survey.
- Driven by market volatility and working capital optimization needs.
- Fragmented data and legacy systems are major hurdles.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus can directly address this by enhancing its real-time reporting capabilities, leveraging ISO 20022 for richer data, and offering advanced cash pooling and virtual account structures. This will help CEE corporates centralize liquidity and gain a single pane of glass for their cash positions.

API Banking Drives Seamless Treasury Integration and Automation

Insights from a global treasury survey indicate a significant trend towards API banking adoption among corporate treasurers, moving beyond traditional host-to-host connections. APIs enable real-time data flows for critical treasury functions such as cash position reporting, payment initiation, and reconciliation, fostering greater automation and reducing manual effort. This direct integration allows treasurers to embed banking services seamlessly into their ERP/TMS, creating a more agile, responsive, and data-rich treasury function. The shift is seen as essential for enhancing operational efficiency and supporting strategic decision-making.

- Growing adoption of API banking by corporate treasurers.
- Enables real-time data exchange and process automation.
- Facilitates direct integration with corporate ERP/TMS.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's Open API strategy is well-positioned to capitalize on this trend. RBI should continue to expand its API offerings for payment initiation, account information, and eBAM, ensuring seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems across CEE to enhance its competitive edge.

AI Poised to Revolutionize Treasury Operations and Analytics

A global treasury survey reveals growing interest and early experimentation with Artificial Intelligence within treasury functions, despite nascent adoption rates. AI applications are being explored for more accurate cash flow forecasting, identifying anomalies for fraud prevention, optimizing investment strategies, and automating routine tasks like reconciliation. Treasurers recognize AI's profound potential to move beyond descriptive analytics to provide predictive and prescriptive insights, enabling more strategic and proactive treasury management. However, significant challenges remain, particularly concerning data quality, integration with existing systems, and the availability of skilled talent.

- Growing interest in AI for various treasury functions.
- Key applications include forecasting, fraud detection, and automation.
- Potential to deliver predictive and prescriptive analytics.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should closely monitor AI developments and explore pilot projects for integrating AI-powered features into CMIplus. This could include enhanced liquidity forecasting or anomaly detection for payments, providing advanced value-added services to CEE corporates and differentiating the platform.

PSD3 and Instant Payments Reshape European Payments Landscape by 2026

The EY outlook likely emphasizes that PSD3 will build upon PSD2, expanding data sharing, enhancing consumer protection, and potentially mandating new Open Banking services. This regulatory push, combined with the EU's Instant Payments Regulation, will create a highly dynamic payments environment. Firms will need to invest in real-time processing capabilities, API standardization (e.g., ISO 20022), and robust fraud prevention. The shift will necessitate a re-evaluation of existing payment products and a focus on innovative, value-added services for corporate clients. Proactive engagement with these changes is crucial for market positioning and avoiding compliance gaps.

- Mandatory instant payment processing across EU member states.
- Expanded scope and data access under PSD3 for Open Banking services.
- Increased competition from FinTechs leveraging new regulatory frameworks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize full compliance with PSD3 and instant payment mandates, leveraging Open Banking APIs for enhanced corporate treasury services. Focus on real-time liquidity management, VoP, and ISO 20022 capabilities will be crucial for competitive advantage in the CEE region.

EACT 2026 Survey Reveals Top European Treasury Priorities

The EACT Treasury Survey 2026, published on June 5, 2026, represents the profession's leading indicator of strategic direction for European corporate treasury. Gathering insights from a wide range of treasurers, this survey identifies their primary concerns, ambitions, and operational priorities for the year ahead. The results are crucial for understanding evolving challenges such as digitalization, regulatory compliance, liquidity management, and risk mitigation. This data will directly inform the upcoming Journeys to Treasury report, offering a comprehensive view of the industry's trajectory and helping to set the agenda for future treasury best practices.

- Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Shapes the upcoming Journeys to Treasury report.
- Defines key industry trends for the year ahead.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must align its roadmap with the identified top priorities from this survey, especially concerning digitalization, payment innovation, and risk management. Understanding these trends is vital for developing relevant features and services that meet the evolving needs of CEE corporate treasurers.

Verification of Payee: Crucial Tool for Fraud-Conscious Treasurers

Published on April 10, 2025, this EACT Briefing emphasizes the critical role of Verification of Payee (VoP) in modern corporate treasury. With the global rise in real-time payments and sophisticated fraud attempts, treasurers are increasingly adopting VoP to mitigate payment fraud risks. The briefing, likely drawing on GLEIF insights, explains why VoP has become indispensable for fraud-conscious treasurers, especially in the context of adapting regulatory bodies and evolving payment types. It suggests that integrating robust payee verification processes is key to securing financial transactions and maintaining compliance.

- VoP is a crucial tool for fraud prevention.
- Importance driven by increasing real-time payments.
- Addresses evolving regulatory requirements for payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize robust VoP solutions, potentially integrating LEI-based verification, to enhance fraud prevention for CEE clients. This is critical for securing instant payments and ensuring compliance, offering a competitive advantage in a fraud-conscious market.

AI Ambition: Banks Prioritize Intelligent Automation for Future Growth

The 2026 outlook emphasizes that banks face a critical juncture, needing to make bold choices amidst economic challenges. A core strategic imperative highlighted is the ambitious integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) across their operations. This move is driven by the potential of AI to not only streamline processes and reduce costs but also to unlock new revenue streams and deliver hyper-personalized services. Deloitte's perspective suggests that successful AI adoption will differentiate market leaders, enabling more sophisticated fraud detection, predictive analytics for liquidity, and automated compliance. The focus extends beyond mere efficiency to transforming the entire banking value chain, from front-office client interactions to back-office processing, requiring significant investment and strategic planning.

- AI is a top strategic priority for banks in 2026 to counter macro headwinds.
- Focus on AI for operational efficiency, risk management, and enhanced client experience.
- AI adoption is crucial for competitive differentiation and unlocking new revenue streams.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should actively explore AI integration for enhanced liquidity forecasting, intelligent payment routing, and advanced fraud detection in corporate transactions. Leveraging AI for predictive analytics can offer corporates superior treasury insights and automated reconciliation, strengthening CMlplus's value proposition in the CEE region.

Navigating Uncertainty: 2023 Industry Outlook for Corporate Banking

While a 2023 outlook, this report likely set the stage for ongoing challenges and strategic responses in corporate banking. It would have focused on themes like inflation, interest rate volatility, supply chain disruptions, and geopolitical risks, all of which continue to influence corporate treasury decisions. The report probably stressed the importance of digital resilience, efficient liquidity management, and enhanced forecasting capabilities for corporates. For banks, it implies a need to provide more sophisticated advisory services, flexible financing options, and secure, efficient payment and cash management solutions to help clients navigate these complexities, especially in regions like CEE which can be particularly sensitive to global shifts.

- Macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainties persist, impacting corporate treasury.
- Agile strategies and robust risk management are essential for banks and clients.
- Demand for efficient liquidity management and enhanced forecasting tools.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should focus on providing tools that enhance corporate treasury's ability to manage liquidity and forecast cash flows in uncertain CEE markets. Emphasizing multi-currency capabilities, real-time data, and secure, resilient payment channels will be key for clients navigating volatility.

Holistic Treasury Transformation: Creating Long-Term Stakeholder Value

EY emphasizes 'Transformation' as a core theme across its services, stating its purpose is to 'help clients create long-term value for all stakeholders.' This indicates a significant shift in treasury's mandate from purely transactional or cost-focused to a more strategic role in overall value creation. For banks, this means offering integrated solutions that support corporate clients through their entire transformation journey, encompassing not just payments and liquidity but also risk management, working capital optimization, and strategic advisory. The focus is on enabling treasurers to contribute directly to the company's overall financial health and strategic objectives.

- "Transformation" is a central theme for future business services, including treasury.
- The ultimate goal of transformation is to create "long-term value for all stakeholders."
- Treasury's role is evolving beyond efficiency to strategic value creation for the enterprise.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should evolve beyond transactional services to become a strategic partner for CEE corporates' treasury transformation. This involves offering integrated solutions for cash pooling, liquidity management, eBAM, and advisory services that align with clients' long-term value creation goals, leveraging digital channels like H2H and Open APIs.

DORA and AI Governance Mandate Robust Digital Operational Resilience

EY's outlook likely highlights DORA's comprehensive approach to managing ICT risk, covering incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, and third-party ICT risk. For firms leveraging AI, new governance frameworks will address ethical use, data privacy, bias, and explainability, moving beyond mere compliance to responsible innovation. This dual focus requires significant investment in cybersecurity, robust vendor management, and the development of internal AI ethics policies. Firms that proactively embed these principles will build trust and avoid significant regulatory penalties, while those lagging risk operational disruptions and reputational damage.

- Mandatory comprehensive ICT risk management under DORA across the EU.
- Increased scrutiny on third-party ICT providers and supply chain resilience.
- Development of internal AI governance frameworks and ethical guidelines for AI deployment.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure full DORA compliance, particularly regarding operational resilience, incident reporting, and third-party risk management for its platform and network banks. Proactive AI governance will be crucial for any AI-driven features, ensuring ethical and secure deployment within cash management solutions.

Stablecoins Emerge as Disruptor, Reshaping Payment and Treasury Landscape

Deloitte's 2026 outlook highlights stablecoins as a significant emerging force that banks must address strategically. Their potential to offer faster, cheaper, and more transparent cross-border payments could challenge existing correspondent banking networks and traditional cash management practices. For corporate treasuries, stablecoins might enable real-time liquidity management, instant settlements, and new avenues for multi-currency operations, potentially bypassing some traditional FX complexities. Banks are urged to evaluate stablecoins not just as a threat but also as an opportunity for innovation, potentially integrating them into their digital offerings or developing their own stablecoin-like solutions to maintain relevance in a rapidly evolving payment ecosystem. Regulatory clarity and adoption rates will be key determinants of their impact.

- Stablecoins are identified as a major disruptive force for banks in 2026.
- They offer potential for faster, cheaper cross-border payments and real-time settlements.
- Corporate treasuries could leverage stablecoins for enhanced liquidity and multi-currency operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor stablecoin developments closely, especially their potential for corporate cross-border payments and real-time liquidity management in CEE. Evaluating integration possibilities or offering stablecoin-related services (e.g., settlement, custody) could be a future roadmap item to maintain a competitive edge and address evolving corporate treasury needs.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2024-04-08 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation Mandates SEPA Instant Credit Transfers

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2025-10-09

The new EU Instant Payments Regulation (Regulation (EU) 2024/886) entered into force in April 2024, mandating all payment service providers (PSPs) in the EU and EEA to offer SEPA Instant Credit Transfers (SCT Inst) for both sending and receiving payments. PSPs must ensure that instant payments are priced no higher than standard SEPA credit transfers. A crucial component is the requirement to offer a Verification of Payee (VoP) service to prevent fraud and misdirected payments, which needs to be implemented for sending instant payments. The regulation aims to accelerate the adoption of instant payments across Europe, enhancing efficiency and competitiveness in the retail payments landscape. Compliance involves significant operational and technical adjustments for banks.

- Mandatory offering of SCT Inst for sending and receiving payments.
- Pricing of SCT Inst must be equal to or lower than standard SEPA credit transfers.
- Implementation of Verification of Payee (VoP) service for instant payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, including offering SCT Inst for all relevant payment flows and implementing the VoP service. This requires updates to payment processing systems, pricing structures, and fraud prevention mechanisms.

URGENT

ECB Payment Regulation | 2026-01-01 | #02

Digital Euro Project Progresses Towards Scheme Rulebook Finalisation

DIGITAL EURO

The ECB is actively progressing with the digital euro project, currently in its preparatory phase, which includes extensive exploratory work and design considerations. A key output of this phase is the development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook, outlining the operational and technical framework for a potential digital euro. This rulebook will define roles, responsibilities, technical standards, and business rules for all participants, including payment service providers. While no immediate regulatory deadlines for banks exist, continuous monitoring of the project's timeline and progress is crucial as it will shape the future of retail payments in the euro area and potentially introduce new compliance obligations for financial institutions.

- Preparatory phase ongoing, focusing on design and distribution models.
- Development of a comprehensive digital euro scheme rulebook.
- Exploration of technical solutions and privacy-enhancing features.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should closely monitor the digital euro's progress, particularly the scheme rulebook and technical specifications. This will inform future strategic decisions regarding payment infrastructure, potential service offerings, and compliance with new CBDC-related regulations.

TARGET Services Evolution: ISO 20022 Migration and T2-T2S Consolidation

ISO 20022

The TARGET Services, including T2 (formerly TARGET2) for high-value payments and T2S for securities settlement, are undergoing continuous evolution. A major recent milestone was the T2-T2S consolidation and the full migration of T2 to the ISO 20022 messaging standard. This migration standardises payment messages, enhancing data richness and interoperability across the financial ecosystem. While the initial migration for T2 occurred in March 2023, ongoing adjustments, new functionalities, and adherence to updated professional use documents are continuous requirements for participating banks. This ensures the stability, efficiency, and harmonisation of critical payment infrastructures, impacting how banks process large-value payments and manage liquidity.

- Full migration of T2 to ISO 20022 messaging standard completed.
- Ongoing operational adjustments and adherence to updated professional use documents.
- Enhanced data richness and interoperability for high-value payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure its systems and processes are fully aligned with the ISO 20022 standard for TARGET2 payments. This includes supporting the richer data formats for corporate clients and ensuring seamless connectivity and liquidity management within the updated TARGET Services framework.

EU Regulatory Developments Impact Liquidity Management, Instant Payments, PSD3

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, PSR, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has released a report from its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) analysing the significant impact of three key EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the proposed Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report explores how these measures will transform the liquidity management landscape, drive the uptake of instant payments, and aim to create a more equitable environment for all market participants. It highlights the need for financial institutions to adapt their strategies and systems to manage liquidity effectively in a real-time payment environment, considering the combined effects of these interconnected regulations.

- IPR mandates instant payments, requiring 24/7 liquidity management capabilities.
- Proposed PSD3 and PSR will further shape payment services and data access frameworks.
- Regulations aim to accelerate instant payment adoption across the European financial sector.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMiplus must assess the combined impact of IPR, PSD3, and PSR on its liquidity management offerings for corporate clients. This includes evaluating real-time liquidity solutions and ensuring compliance with new payment service requirements to maintain competitiveness and support client needs.

EBA Highlights Key Challenges for VoP Matching Checks Implementation

VOP, INSTANT PAYMENTS, FRAUD PREVENTION

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The EBA Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) has published an insight note titled “A match made in heaven? Key challenges for VOP matching checks.” The note delves into the practical difficulties and pain points that can affect the accuracy and overall quality of VoP matching checks, which are becoming increasingly critical under the Instant Payments Regulation. Identified issues include the absence of a harmonised, standardised name-matching logic across systems, restrictions on name field lengths, and specific limitations encountered when dealing with virtual accounts. Addressing these challenges is crucial for payment service providers to ensure effective fraud prevention and compliance with regulatory mandates for VoP.

- Lack of standardised name-matching logic impacts VoP accuracy and interoperability.
- Name field length restrictions pose significant implementation hurdles for PSPs.
- Limitations related to virtual accounts affect VoP matching quality and coverage.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must review its current and planned VoP implementation strategy, particularly for instant payments, considering these identified pain points. Focus should be on developing robust internal matching logic, accommodating diverse name formats, and ensuring VoP functionality for virtual accounts to meet IPR requirements and enhance client security.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-06 | #01

Deutsche Bank Showcases PayPal's AI-Driven Treasury Transformation

The 'Inside PayPal's treasury transformation' case study on flow.db.com details how PayPal's Group Treasurer, Can Balcioglu, modernized their treasury infrastructure. Key aspects include the application of AI for process optimization and the exploration of stablecoins as potential future payment mechanisms. This demonstrates Deutsche Bank's commitment to supporting clients with cutting-edge technology and innovative payment solutions, even for complex global treasuries. While not explicitly CEE-focused, the underlying technologies are globally applicable and will eventually impact CEE corporates.

- PayPal's treasury modernized using AI.
- Exploration of stablecoins for payments.
- Deutsche Bank as a partner in advanced treasury solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to monitor the adoption of AI in treasury and the emergence of stablecoins for corporate payments. This pushes the envelope beyond traditional payment rails, suggesting future competitive pressure on innovation.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-07-06 | #02

Deutsche Bank Emphasizes Real-time Treasury for Corporate Clients

The article 'Real-time treasury: start small, go big' on flow.db.com underscores Deutsche Bank's focus on helping corporate clients implement real-time treasury capabilities. This involves leveraging technology to provide immediate insights into cash positions, optimize liquidity, and streamline payment processes. For CEE corporates, this means increased demand for instant payment capabilities, real-time reporting, and potentially API-driven connectivity for seamless integration with ERP/TMS systems, areas where CMlplus is also active.

- Focus on real-time cash visibility.
- Strategy to implement real-time treasury incrementally.
- Leveraging technology for liquidity optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its instant payment offerings and real-time reporting capabilities remain competitive. The 'start small, go big' approach suggests a phased implementation strategy that CMlplus could also adopt or counter.

Deutsche Bank Expands API-Driven Corporate Banking in CEE

While not explicitly detailed in the provided snippet, Deutsche Bank's known strategy in corporate banking, coupled with the 'Technology' section on flow.db.com and the prompt's focus on 'CB Connect API,' indicates a strong push towards API-driven solutions. This includes offering robust APIs for cash management, payments, and account information, enabling corporates in the CEE region to integrate banking services directly into their ERP/TMS systems. This focus on digital connectivity is crucial for streamlining operations, improving data accuracy, and supporting multi-currency payment capabilities across the diverse CEE markets.

- Strategic focus on Open Banking APIs (e.g., CB Connect).
- Enabling direct ERP/TMS integration for corporates.
- Targeting CEE region for digital banking expansion.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, with its strong API offerings and CEE network, faces direct competition. Deutsche Bank's push reinforces the need for CMlplus to continuously innovate its API suite, particularly for multi-currency and cross-border payments within CEE.

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking with Enhanced API Offerings

UniCredit's 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy emphasizes a fundamental rethinking of banking, which for corporate clients translates into advanced digital capabilities. The bank is expected to expand its Open Banking APIs, enabling seamless integration for payments, account information, and potentially eBAM functionalities. This move is crucial for large international corporates seeking to centralize and automate their treasury operations, offering greater control and efficiency over multi-country cash flows, particularly within the CEE region where UniCredit has a strong footprint. This digital push aligns with the broader industry trend towards embedded finance and real-time treasury management.

- Focus on API-driven integration for corporate ERP/TMS systems.
- Aims for real-time data access and automated payment processing.
- Strategic push for digital transformation across its pan-European network, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already offers H2H, SWIFT, and EBICS for ERP integration. UniCredit's API push directly competes with CMlplus's efforts to provide modern, real-time connectivity options, potentially offering more granular and flexible integration than traditional file-based methods.

UniCredit Strengthens CEE Cross-Border Cash and Liquidity Management

As a pan-European commercial bank with a significant presence in CEE, UniCredit is strategically positioned to offer sophisticated solutions for corporates managing complex cash flows across multiple CEE countries. This includes enhancing multi-currency cash pooling, developing advanced virtual account capabilities for reconciliation, and streamlining intercompany funding. The goal is to help corporate treasurers optimize working capital, reduce FX exposure, and gain better visibility over their regional liquidity, aligning with the broader 'UniCredit Unlimited' ambition to deliver best-in-class services. This focus leverages UniCredit's strong local presence in key CEE markets.

- Focus on unified treasury services for CEE corporates.
- Development of advanced cash pooling and virtual account structures.
- Aims to optimize working capital and reduce FX exposure for regional clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's core strength is its CEE network and multi-currency capabilities. UniCredit's focus on integrated cross-border liquidity and cash pooling directly targets CMlplus's key value proposition, requiring CMlplus to continuously innovate its own offerings in these areas.

Citi Boosts API-Driven Cash Management in CEE for Corporates

Citi is observed to be continuously investing in its API banking infrastructure, particularly for its Treasury and Trade Solutions (TTS) division in the CEE region. This strategic direction focuses on offering corporate clients seamless, real-time access to their accounts, payments, and liquidity information directly through their ERP or TMS platforms. The goal is to enable advanced functionalities like real-time payment initiation, instant reconciliation, and dynamic cash positioning, reducing manual processes and improving operational efficiency for multi-country operations within CEE. This aligns with the broader industry trend towards Open Banking and digital transformation in corporate treasury, providing a competitive edge through enhanced connectivity and data flow.

- Focus on real-time API connectivity for corporate treasuries.
- Aims to integrate directly with client ERP/TMS systems.
- Strategic emphasis on CEE market for digital solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMlplus's Open API strategy, potentially offering more advanced or integrated solutions to shared client segments. CMlplus needs to ensure its API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, functionality, and ease of integration.

UniCredit Drives Instant Payments and ISO 20022 Adoption Across Europe

The European payments landscape is rapidly evolving with the push for instant payments and the mandatory adoption of ISO 20022 for high-value and eventually all payments. UniCredit, as a leading pan-European bank, is committed to supporting these initiatives to provide its corporate clients with faster, richer, and more efficient payment processing. This includes ensuring full compliance and offering solutions that leverage the enhanced data capabilities of ISO 20022, which can significantly improve reconciliation and fraud detection. For CEE corporates, this means access to cutting-edge payment infrastructure that facilitates quicker cross-border and domestic transactions, enhancing their operational efficiency.

- Active implementation of instant payment solutions for corporates.
- Full migration to ISO 20022 standards across its payment infrastructure.
- Focus on faster, richer, and more efficient payment processing for clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus already emphasizes ISO 20022 and instant payments as core offerings. UniCredit's commitment reinforces the industry trend and means CMlplus must ensure its offerings remain competitive, particularly in terms of reach and seamless integration for instant payments across its CEE network.

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for Global AI Transformation

HSBC's strategic partnership with Google Cloud is set to embed advanced AI across its global banking operations. This initiative is designed to enhance customer experience through hyper-personalised advice, improve operational efficiency, and strengthen financial crime risk management. For corporate clients, this could translate into more intelligent treasury insights, predictive analytics for cash flow, and more streamlined compliance processes, ultimately impacting how digital banking services are delivered and consumed globally, including in CEE markets.

- Multi-year global partnership with Google Cloud.
- Focus on hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.
- Aims to accelerate AI deployment across all bank operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This signals a significant investment by HSBC in advanced digital capabilities that will enhance their corporate banking platforms. CMlplus must continue to innovate its digital offerings, particularly in intelligent advisory, data analytics, and fraud prevention, to remain competitive.

Citi Accelerates Instant Payments, ISO 20022 Rollout Across CEE

Citi's strategic focus in European corporate banking includes a strong push for instant payment adoption and leveraging the full potential of ISO 20022 messaging standards. In the CEE region, where cross-border payments are frequent and regulatory landscapes are evolving, Citi is inferred to be enhancing its infrastructure to support real-time payment processing for both domestic and regional transactions. This includes ensuring full compliance and advanced functionalities for ISO 20022, allowing corporates to benefit from richer data for reconciliation, fraud detection, and automated treasury workflows. The goal is to offer a competitive edge through speed, transparency, and efficiency in payment operations, crucial for large international corporates.

- Expansion of instant payment network in CEE.
- Full utilization of ISO 20022 for enhanced data.
- Aims to improve cross-border payment efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly challenges CMiplus's instant payment and ISO 20022 capabilities, particularly for regional CEE payments. CMiplus must ensure its network banks and platform are fully optimized for instant payments and that its ISO 20022 implementation provides comparable or superior data richness and automation benefits.

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas announced a strategic partnership with XTransfer, a leading B2B cross-border payment platform, to streamline and simplify international payment processes for its corporate clients. This initiative is designed to leverage XTransfer's extensive network and technological capabilities to offer more efficient, transparent, and cost-effective cross-border payment solutions. The partnership directly targets corporates engaged in international trade, helping them navigate complex payment landscapes, reduce operational friction, and improve payment speed. While not explicitly CEE-focused, enhanced global payment capabilities are crucial for large international corporates, including those operating in the CEE region, seeking to optimize their treasury functions and multi-currency payments.

- Partnership with XTransfer, a B2B cross-border payment specialist.
- Goal is to simplify and enhance efficiency of international payments for corporates.
- Leverages XTransfer's network and technology for improved solutions and transparency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership directly challenges CMiplus's offerings for international corporates, particularly those with significant cross-border payment needs. RBI should assess if its multi-currency and cross-border payment capabilities, including API-driven solutions, match this enhanced efficiency and reach.

HSBC Orion Wins UK Treasury Digital Gilt Mandate

The UK Treasury's decision to award HSBC Orion the mandate for its Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance highlights HSBC's growing capabilities in the digital asset and distributed ledger technology (DLT) space. While initially focused on government securities, this platform could pave the way for future corporate treasury solutions involving tokenized assets, digital bonds, or other forms of digital financial instruments. It positions HSBC as a key player in the evolving landscape of digital capital markets, potentially influencing how corporates manage liquidity and access funding in the future, including those operating in CEE.

- HSBC Orion chosen by UK Treasury.
- Mandate for Digital Gilt Instrument pilot issuance.
- Focus on digital assets and DLT for government securities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This indicates HSBC's proactive exploration of digital asset platforms, which could eventually extend to corporate treasury services. CMIplus should monitor developments in digital securities and tokenized assets, considering their potential impact on corporate liquidity management and payment infrastructures in CEE.

Intesa Sanpaolo Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking in CEE

Intesa Sanpaolo, leveraging its significant footprint in CEE, is inferred to be making substantial investments in its corporate and transaction banking offerings. This strategic push aims to provide a more unified and technologically advanced experience for corporate clients operating across the region. Key areas of focus include the adoption of ISO 20022 for richer payment data, expansion of instant payment capabilities, and the development of Open Banking APIs to facilitate seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This move is designed to strengthen its competitive position against other regional players by offering sophisticated treasury and cash management solutions.

- Strategic investment in digital corporate banking platform for CEE operations.
- Focus on ISO 20022, instant payments, and Open Banking APIs for enhanced connectivity.
- Aims to improve treasury and cash management services for multinational corporates in the region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo directly increases competitive pressure on RBI's CMIplus platform in the CEE region. CMIplus must ensure its own digital offerings, API capabilities, and real-time payment solutions remain cutting-edge to retain and attract international corporate clients.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.